- private: private properties of a class only can be accessible by the *methods inside the class*. The methods of the class will be introduced a little later.
- protected: protected properties are similar to the private properties except that protected properties can be accessible by the subclasses. You will learn about the subclasses and inheritance later.
- public: public properties can be accessible not only by the methods inside but also by the code outside of the class.

Remember

The data/ variables inside a class (ex: var $name;) are called 'properties'.

In the BankAccount class, we can only access those properties of the bank account inside the class.

6.1.4 Methods

Behaviors of the object or class are called methods. Similar to the class properties, the methods can have three different visibility levels: private, protected, and public.

With a bank account, we can deposit money, withdraw money and get the balance. In addition, we need methods to set the bank account number and get the bank account number. The bank account number is used to distinguish from one bank account to the other.

Keyword

Function was originally the idealization of how a varying quantity depends on another quantity.

To create a method for a class you use the function keyword followed by the name and parentheses. A method is similar to a function except that a method is associated with a class and has a visibility level. Like a **function**, a method can have one or more parameter and can return a value.

Let's add some methods to the BankAccount class:

```
<?php
class BankAccount{
 /**
 * bank account number
 * @var string bank account number
 */
 private $accountNumber;
 /**
 * total balance
```